SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-19 Monday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply-Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price

91.05 USD/dmt

FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX

As of preparation: 2026-10-19 18:01:08 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-19 17:45:33 (UTC+8)

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

682.5 yuan/mt

▲ +10.0 +1.49%

MTD avg **678.2**

As of Oct 19 · vs Oct 16

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 19

Index	Value	Change	MTD avg
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily	661 yuan/wmt	▲ +5 +0.76%	659
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily	617 yuan/wmt	▲ +3 +0.49%	620
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily	820 yuan/wmt	▲ +5 +0.61%	821
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily	90.90 USD/dmt	▲ +1.50 +1.68%	90.59
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily	107.95 USD/dmt	▲ +0.20 +0.19%	109.38
SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily	796.81 yuan/mt	▼ -24.77 -3.01%	818.50

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index: As of Oct 16 · vs Oct 15

Key View

Futures and quotations recover together, but sustained trading will determine the rebound's scope

Today's recovery extended across futures, port spot and seaborne markets, but better prices should still be distinguished from stronger demand. DCE most-traded closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, up 1.49%; all three port indices rose, the seaborne 61% index reached USD 90.90/dmt and the 65% reached 107.95, with all 12 brands higher. Price moves were broadly aligned, yet SMM reported needs-based buying and subdued trading, leaving the rebound in need of more persistent transaction support.

Supply flows and costs offer a cushion. In the week to Oct 16, arrivals in China fell 12.07% WoW and global shipments fell 4.72%; freight eased further and average import margins expanded modestly. Lower arrivals do not immediately absorb existing port stocks, while recovering Brazilian shipments show differing supply schedules across origins. Tight regional concentrate resources and improved local purchases may support some domestic markets without establishing a nationwide demand recovery.

The immediate test is whether restocking moves beyond purchases for immediate needs. Stronger orders and mill profitability could provide a firmer basis for the recovery; continued thin trading could leave existing stocks constraining upside. Coke producers' proposed increases from Oct 21 still require market acceptance and may influence cost expectations. A range-bound view remains appropriate while watching transactions, production and inventories for confirmation.

Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures and spot prices recovered.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **682.5 yuan/mt**, up 10.0 yuan (+1.49%) from Oct 16. Qingdao PB Fines were 648, Newman Fines 651 and Mac Fines 653 yuan/wmt, each up 6 yuan from SMM's preceding quotation; BRBF at 703 and Carajas Fines at 823 each rose 11 yuan.
- **Seaborne indices and brand quotations rose together.** The 61% index was **USD 90.90/dmt**, up 1.50 (+1.68%), and the 65% was **107.95**, up 0.20 (+0.19%). All 12 brands increased against the Oct 16 report, with PB Fines at 91.25, Newman Fines 90.35 and Mac Fines 90.65 USD/dmt.
- **Port indices rose while the seaborne grade spread narrowed.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 661, 617 and 820 yuan/wmt, changing by +5, +3 and +5 yuan. The seaborne 65%-61% spread narrowed from USD 18.35 to 17.05/dmt.
- **Latest arrivals declined while mill buying remained needs-based.** Arrivals in China were 24.5464 million mt in the week to Oct 16, down 12.07% WoW; global shipments fell 4.72% to 32.5276 million mt. SMM's daily review described needs-based mill purchases and subdued overall trading, leaving the durability of the price recovery dependent on transactions.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-19 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	648	▲ +6 +0.93%	646	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	651	▲ +6 +0.93%	649	*
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	653	▲ +6 +0.93%	649	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	703	▲ +11 +1.59%	697	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	838	▲ +1 +0.12%	841	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	510	▲ +6 +1.19%	508	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	823	▲ +11 +1.35%	826	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	833	▲ +7 +0.85%	835	*

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-19 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-16
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	87.75	▲ +1.55 +1.80%	86.20
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	89.45	▲ +1.55 +1.76%	87.90
PB Fines 62% Daily	91.25	▲ +1.50 +1.67%	89.75
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	90.35	▲ +1.50 +1.69%	88.85
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	90.65	▲ +1.50 +1.68%	89.15
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	87.55	▲ +1.75 +2.04%	85.80
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	107.40	▲ +1.80 +1.70%	105.60
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	97.80	▲ +1.85 +1.93%	95.95
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	97.50	▲ +1.75 +1.83%	95.75
RTX Fines 61% Daily	86.45	▲ +1.65 +1.95%	84.80
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	90.85	▲ +1.55 +1.74%	89.30
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	80.30	▲ +1.85 +2.36%	78.45

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.59	-6.13%	-14.2%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	109.38	-4.41%	-11.0%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	659	-4.78%	-18.7%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	821	-2.20%	-8.8%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	620	-4.27%	-14.1%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	818.50	-2.39%	-10.1%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 90.90/dmt (+1.68%) and the 65% was 107.95 (+0.19%), narrowing their spread from USD 18.35 to 17.05/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 661, 617 and 820 yuan/wmt, up 5, 3 and 5 yuan.

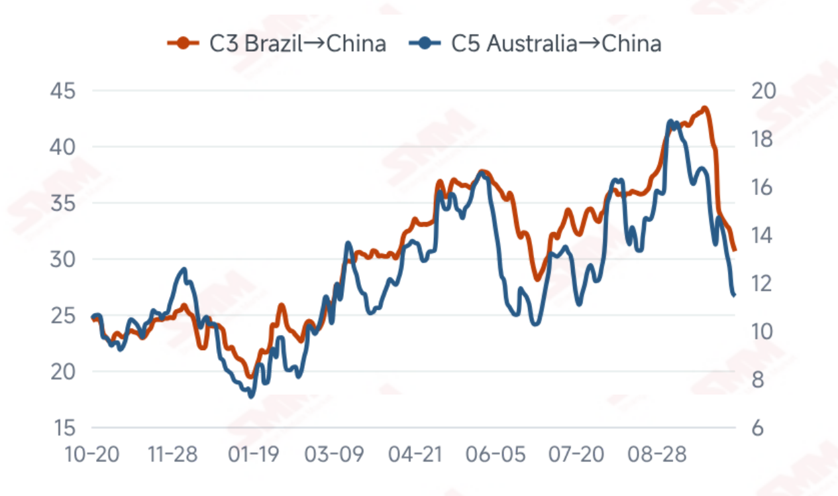
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

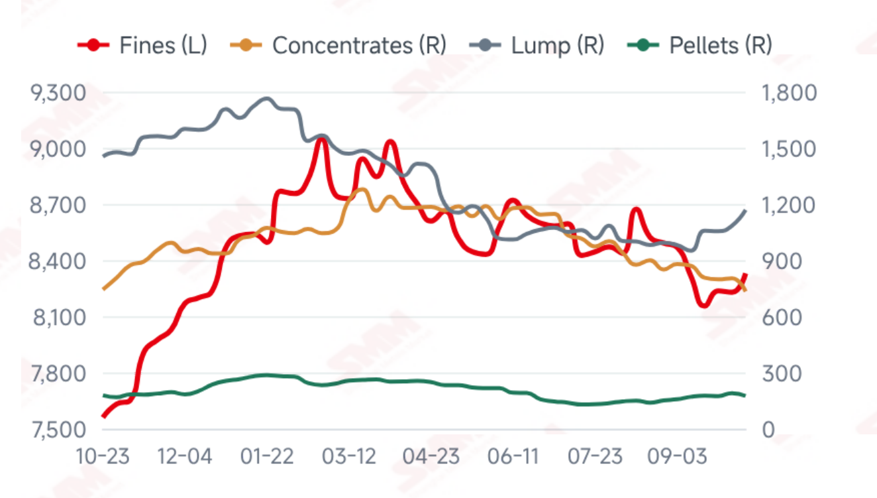
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



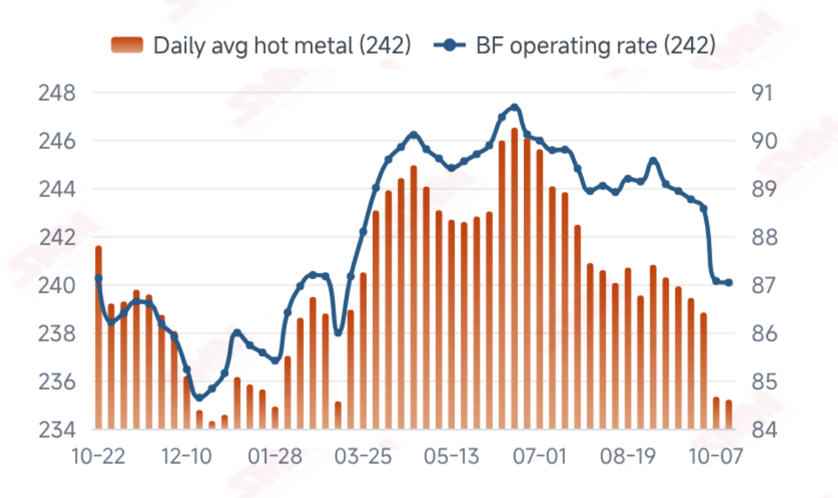
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



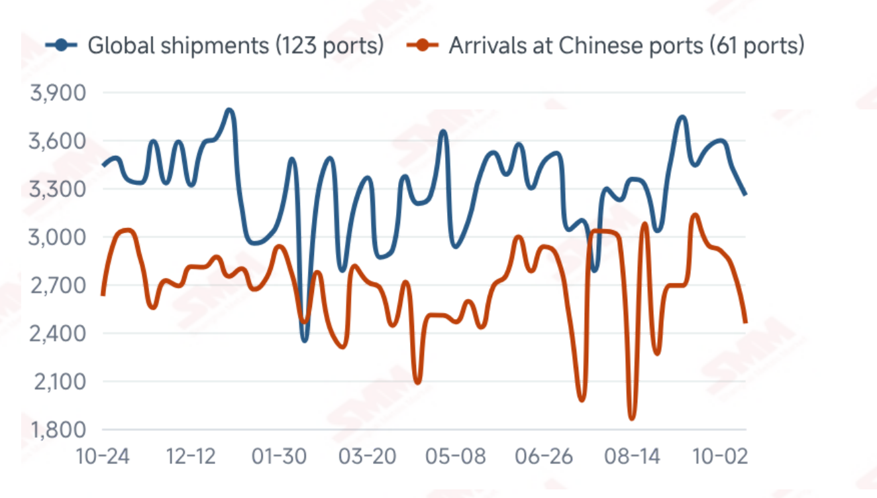
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, up 1.49% from the previous session. Qingdao PB Fines were 648, Newman Fines 651, Mac Fines 653 and SSF 510 yuan/wmt, each up 6 yuan; BRBF at 703 and Carajas Fines at 823 each rose 11 yuan. Newman Lump was 838 (+1) and PB Lump 833 (+7). SMM reported needs-based mill buying and subdued trading. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 91.05/dmt, timestamped Oct 19, 17:45:33 (UTC+8).
Drivers	Domestic futures, port spot and seaborne quotations recovered together, suggesting some improvement in short-term pricing. Lower arrivals may ease pressure on parts of the spot market, but subdued trading is insufficient to establish a broad recovery in buying. The 61% seaborne index rose more than the 65%, narrowing their spread. Brand availability, blending needs and purchasing schedules may all influence this pattern; a single session does not establish a trend reversal.
Demand	SMM's daily review indicated that mills continued buying to immediate needs, with end-user demand and profitability constraints still present. The latest available 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3520 million mt on Oct 14, down 1,200 mt from Oct 7, and a blast furnace operating rate of 87.03%. A narrower decline may ease concerns about further contraction, but output has not turned higher; sustained buying still needs support from margins and orders.
Inventory & supply	Global shipments were 32.5276 million mt in the week to Oct 16, down 1.6117 million mt (-4.72%) WoW. Australia shipped 18.6396 million mt (-4.45%) and Brazil 7.9581 million mt (+13.32%). Arrivals in China fell 3.3683 million mt (-12.07%) to 24.5464 million mt. The latest ten-port stock reading was 104.0212 million mt on Oct 15, up 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30. Lower arrival flows do not imply that existing stocks have already declined; subsequent absorption depends on mill collections and trading.
Cost & margin	SMM's Oct 19 assessment put the period's average imported ore margin at 6.38 yuan/mt, up 0.37 yuan from 6.01; this measures import trading rather than steelmaking profitability. Oct 16 freight was USD 30.60/mt for C3 (-2.52%) and 11.42 for C5 (-1.55%). The day's coke briefing reported that leading producers proposed increases of 50 yuan/mt for wet-quenched and 55 yuan/mt for dry-quenched coke, intended to take effect at midnight on Oct 21. This proposal should not be treated as a broadly implemented cost increase on Oct 19.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 796.81 yuan/mt on Oct 16. SMM's Oct 19 Shandong brief quoted 64% basic concentrate at 755 yuan/mt, down 4 yuan, on a dry-basis, pre-tax ex-mine quotation payable by acceptance bill. Region, grade and payment terms distinguish it from the national index.
Supply & demand	SMM's Shandong brief described normal mine operations, tight local resources, improved mill purchasing appetite and no stocks at local miners. Separately, a production and sales survey published Oct 19 reported sampled mine utilisation of 58.2%, up 0.9 percentage point WoW, concentrate output of 900,000 mt, up 30,000 mt, and stocks of about 243,000 mt, down 20,000 mt. National survey results and regional descriptions should be considered separately.
Outlook	SMM expects prices at Shandong mines and beneficiation plants may edge up, an outlook rather than evidence that today's quotation has risen. Persistent buying improvement and tight regional supply could strengthen sellers' bargaining power, while pressure on mill margins and demand could limit increases.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

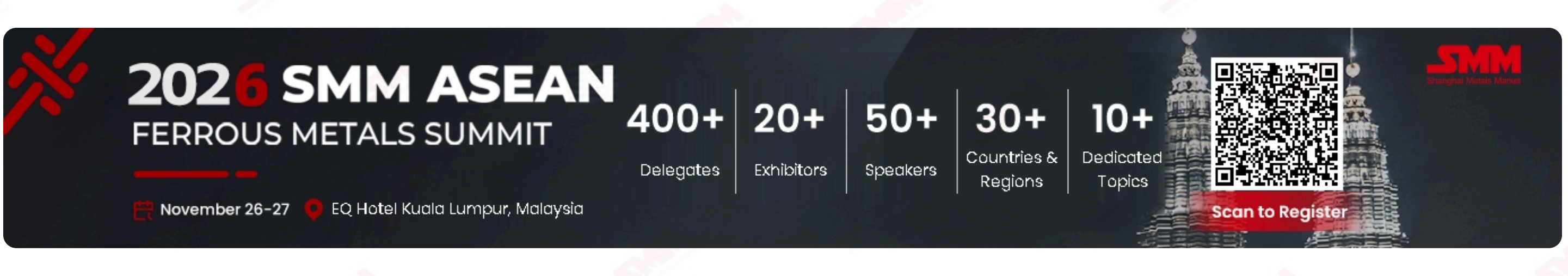
- DCE, port spot and seaborne quotations recovered together.
- All 12 seaborne brands rose against the previous report.
- Latest Chinese arrivals fell 12.07% WoW and global shipments 4.72%.
- Freight eased further and average import margins improved modestly.

▼ Bearish factors

- SMM reported needs-based mill buying and subdued overall trading.
- The latest ten-port stock reading was higher than before the holiday, requiring time for absorption.
- The latest hot metal reading had not turned higher, leaving the demand trend in focus.
- Acceptance of proposed coke increases could renew cost pressure in some operations.

Flash News

- Port stocks build despite lower arrivals; iron ore upside limited [SMM Daily Iron Ore Brief] ↗
  2026-10-19
- [Brief Comment on Chinese Iron Ore] Prices at mines and beneficiation plants in Shandong may edge up slightly ↗
  2026-10-19
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261019 ↗
  2026-10-19
- [SMM Steel] European HRC: Weak Demand Limits Upside Momentum as Supply Curtailments Support Range-Bound Trading ↗
  2026-10-19
- [SMM Steel] Turkish Flat Steel: Domestic and Foreign Trade Stalemate Deepens as TRQs and CBAM Reshape Export Routes ↗
  2026-10-19
- [SMM Steel] Indian HRC and Billet Prices Hold Flat as Festive Season Slows Trading ↗
  2026-10-19


2026 SMM ASEAN FERROUS METALS SUMMIT
November 26-27 EQ Hotel Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia
400+ Delegates
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50+ Speakers
30+ Countries & Regions
10+ Dedicated Topics
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Contact Us - (Email :prices@mmiprices.com)

Shu Qing
Domestic Information Sales
+86 187 8199 7577

Wang Jiahui
Domestic Information Sales
+86 155 2492 4450

Leah Zhang
Overseas Information Sales
+86 136 6193 3462

Jack Teah
Overseas Analyst
+60 11 6680 1225

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